

Morning Window Checklist

Date: _____ Launch: _____

NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Check wind, waves, and tide for your window in FishCrew Tools
- ☐ Set your no-go limits (wind, wave height, lightning, fog)
- ☐ Confirm crew, meeting point, and time in the trip chat
- ☐ Leave a float plan with someone ashore: where, who, back by when
- ☐ Charge phone, radio, and lights; pack chargers

BOAT CHECK

- ☐ Drain plug in
- ☐ Fuel: one third out, one third back, one third spare
- ☐ Battery, bilge pump, and engine cut-off lanyard
- ☐ Anchor and line

FISHING

- ☐ Licenses for everyone who fishes
- ☐ Size, bag, and season limits for target species
- ☐ Bait, ice, cooler, and tackle

NOTES

SAFETY GEAR ON BOARD

- ☐ A wearable life jacket for every person, sized to fit
- ☐ Throwable flotation device
- ☐ VHF radio or phone in a waterproof case
- ☐ Visual distress signals, in date
- ☐ Fire extinguisher, charged
- ☐ Horn or whistle
- ☐ First-aid kit, sunscreen, and water
- ☐ Navigation lights if you leave before sunrise

DOCK BRIEFING (2 MINUTES)

- ☐ Headcount, and where the life jackets and radio are
- ☐ Who runs the boat if the captain cannot
- ☐ Person-overboard plan
- ☐ Turn-back rule: if conditions pass your limits, head in

GO / NO-GO

My limits today: wind under _____ kt waves under _____ ft no lightning in the forecast

Forecast checked at _____ (time). Decision: [] GO [] WAIT [] NO-GO

When in doubt, stay at the dock. Conditions change fast; check again before you launch.

This checklist is a reminder, not a complete list. Follow U.S. Coast Guard carriage rules and your local and state boating and fishing regulations.
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